



Certificate Programmes for Engineers

Training Institutes Supplement

Certification Facelift for Career Uplift

Making every company crave for their skill set is a dream that most engineers harbour. Certifications help them live that dream, equipping them with essential knowledge and hands-on experience to increase their employability quotient

■ VANISHA JOSEPH

Ever noticed goods on a beam balance when you go shopping? Those need to outweigh the weights to enter your shopping basket. Similar is the situation of engineering students stepping into professional shoes. They have to outperform competitors in skill sets to get into a good company. Thus, they have to constantly be on a look out for opportunities that help them develop extra skills to set them apart, and get noticed by employers.

The situation is no different for experienced engineers, many of whom jostle against stagnation. They also search for ways to improve their profiles and make themselves more marketable.

Certification is one such makeweight that promises to give both experienced engineers and freshers the extra edge; increasing their employability quotient and helping them outsmart competitors.

"The IT field has witnessed fast changes and developments, making it essential for engineers to keep up

with varied languages, applications and products. For engineers, practical and academic knowledge is important, and certifications are a quick and effective way of learning innovations to keep their knowledge and skills up-to-date. Certifications serve as yardsticks, determining the potential of engineers who can play a strategic role within the company. They gauge the ability of an engineer," says Aanal Bhagwati, owner, CareerValue Solutions, a Bangalore-based human resource management firm.

Industry experts couldn't agree more. "There is a huge mismatch between industry requirements and skill sets of students passing out every year, as they lack hands-on experience. Every company wants to hire people with right skills that can give them return on investment (ROI) from the day one of their joining," says Lokesh Mehra, regional manager, corporate responsibility, Cisco South Asia.

"With technological changes at a very fast pace, working/experienced professionals too need to acquire specialised skills to fill knowledge gaps that come

along with innovations," he adds.

Naveen Kumar, CEO, Emtech Foundation, a training institute that provides embedded system certifications, says: "Certification courses help increase your demand in the current scenario, where industry requirements are becoming specific. Your résumé needs to match up to these requirements. The industry wants engineers who can adapt to their work culture as soon as possible. This is where certifications play a huge role."

How do certifications help?

Be it getting freshers ready to fly into action from day one, or improving chances of growth for the experienced, or beating recession blues, certifications can help boost the career of engineers. "Vendor certification provides competitive edge, skill differentiation and credibility in the job market. It helps in aligning credentials for job roles, which makes it easier to understand skills requirement for an open position and helps in making accurate hiring decisions," says Tarun Agarwal, director—Technology & Learning



"If I am looking for talent for new projects, I instantly search for people having certifications of the skillsets required for that project."

—Lokesh Mehra, regional manager, corporate responsibility, Cisco South Asia



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"Certifications help freshers acquire relevant skill sets keeping them at par with current and future trends of the industry."

—SS Bhowmick, director, Nex-G Exuberant Solutions



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"Certifications help freshers gain job-specific knowledge that will ultimately lead to employability."

—Varada Murthy, CEO, People First HR Consultants